

S05-05 - Soul-Audit Wraiths

Player read-aloud

The wraiths drift closer. Their faces are the shape of remembered shame.

Scene summary

Soul-Audit Wraiths attack memory, vulnerability, and the party's tether to their bodies.

Visible choices

- Prioritize wraiths
- Use magic
- Protect vulnerable ally
- Defeat skeletons to tick countdown

Player questions

- What detail in Soul-Audit Wraiths tells you the official story is incomplete?
- Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it?
- What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?

GM notes

- Use Pass-Through sparingly. Do not lock too many PCs out of play at once.
- Keep player-facing information actionable. Reveal systemic truth through objects, reactions, and consequences before naming it.
- Manufactured-threat lens: seed the contradiction, do not explain it. The surface goal stays simple and heroic.
- [REFLAVOR/GUARANTEED] Soul-Audit Wraiths bear audit glyphs and say, "Unlicensed soul-resonance detected. Submit for audit."
- [ADD/GUARANTEED] A defeated wraith leaves a Soulspire compliance tag or coil-credit token instead of natural remains.
- [ADD/EARNED] Wraiths ignore forest creatures and home only on ritual soul-magic. (Instinct Medium 15)
- [ADD/EARNED] A player can read the markings and name Soulspire without the GM naming it first. (Knowledge Medium 15)

Checks and rolls

- Presence Resist fear or speak a human truth against the audit. Standard Reduce pressure on the ritual. 15 Cleanly resolve: Resist fear or speak a human truth against the audit. Add a concrete boon, extra clue, or improved position. Success, plus the player names one helpful detail or asks one follow-up question. Success, but the GM exposes a cost, ticks a countdown, or reveals a new pressure tied to Soul-Audit Wraiths. The full goal slips, but the party still learns a useful truth or avoids the worst consequence. The GM makes a hard move that follows from the

fiction and leaves the next choice visible. Spend Fear to tick the ritual countdown, expose the Custodian, activate ward backlash, or trigger Market Correction. On mixed or sliding results, reveal information in layers: visible fact, actionable clue, then systemic truth.

- Knowledge Identify the memory shard pattern. Standard Reveal exploitative infrastructure history. 15 Cleanly resolve: Identify the memory shard pattern. Add a concrete boon, extra clue, or improved position. Success, plus the player names one helpful detail or asks one follow-up question. Success, but the GM exposes a cost, ticks a countdown, or reveals a new pressure tied to Soul-Audit Wraiths. The full goal slips, but the party still learns a useful truth or avoids the worst consequence. The GM makes a hard move that follows from the fiction and leaves the next choice visible. Spend Fear to tick the ritual countdown, expose the Custodian, activate ward backlash, or trigger Market Correction. On mixed or sliding results, reveal information in layers: visible fact, actionable clue, then systemic truth.

Clues

- Memory shard These are memories. The ward failure monetized fear. The wraiths carry lives reduced to ledger events.
- Guaranteed seed Soul-Audit Wraiths bear audit glyphs and say, "Unlicensed soul-resonance detected. Submit for audit." Soul-Audit Wraiths bear audit glyphs and say, "Unlicensed soul-resonance detected. Submit for audit."
- Guaranteed seed A defeated wraith leaves a Soulspire compliance tag or coil-credit token instead of natural remains. A defeated wraith leaves a Soulspire compliance tag or coil-credit token instead of natural remains.
- Earned seed Available if players investigate, show mercy, or ask the right question. Wraiths ignore forest creatures and home only on ritual soul-magic. Instinct Medium 15
- Earned seed Available if players investigate, show mercy, or ask the right question. A player can read the markings and name Soulspire without the GM naming it first. Knowledge Medium 15

Loot

- Use Wraith memory shards table

Mechanics

- Plot So Far: The party is in Act Five pressure: Soul-Audit Wraiths attack memory, vulnerability, and the party's tether to their bodies.
- Mechanics In Play: Use Daggerheart Duality Dice as baseline. Use the listed Difficulty and outcome options when a roll matters. Keep trivial actions no-roll; roll only when uncertainty, cost, or danger is interesting.
- Roll Cards: s05-05-ground-an-untethered-ally S05-05 Ground an Untethered ally Ground an Untethered ally Presence Knowledge Presence Knowledge 13 Presence calls them back; Knowledge disputes the audit logic. A soul stays loose while the ritual strains. Critical Success: best possible version of the action; gain Hope and clear 1 Stress. Add an extra benefit that follows from the fiction. Success with Hope: the

PC gets what they wanted and gains Hope. Keep the position clean or generous.

Success with Fear: the PC gets what they wanted, but the GM gains Fear and introduces a cost, complication, or pressure. Failure with Hope: the PC does not get the full result, but gains Hope and receives a useful thread, clue, or safer next option. Failure with Fear: the PC fails and the GM gains Fear. Make a hard move that follows from the fiction. A soul stays loose while the ritual strains. Use a hard...

- Gm Fear Spends: Tick the Ritual Countdown the wrong direction or expose the Custodian. Trigger Market Correction, Pass-Through, Memory Delve, or Group Attack when fiction supports it.
- Conditions Hazards: Vulnerable
- Module Effects: Soul-Audit Wraith module effect: Untethered. Keep it inside that feature/scene and do not list it as a global condition.
- Search Loot Clues: Wraith remains: cold ash, translucent memory shard, unpaid promise echo.
- No Roll Guidance: Do not call for a roll when the players have time, a clear method, and no meaningful pressure.
- Escalation: Escalate by making cost visible: time, noise, trust, ward instability, or someone vulnerable in danger.
- Deescalation: De-escalate through respect, care, honest testimony, useful evidence, or a concrete concession.
- Tv Mechanics Caption: Public cue: Soul-Audit Wraiths asks what the party does, what it costs, and who is protected.
- Trait Variety Note: Primary traits in this scene: Instinct, Knowledge, Presence. If rolls drift toward Instinct/Presence, ask whether Agility, Strength, Finesse, or Knowledge better describes the action.
- Class Community Ancestry Reveals: Loreborne: spots older legal, heraldic, or ward-craft language under the branding. Underborne: notices service doors, hidden routes, and who built the thing nobody credits. Highborne: reads etiquette, class panic, and reputational risk. Ridgeborne: notices stonework, weight, pressure, and structural weakness. Wildborne: reads the land, animals, and local ecological stress. Elf/Ribbet/Human/Giant/Katari: invite one sensory or social detail from the player's heritage. Sorcerer/Rogue/Warrior/Guardian/Ranger: give each class one table-facing way to shine without changing the plot.

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